

Saving the best for last

Last month had the biggest red letter day for Google in 2017. On October 4th, Google unleashed a whole suite of products at #Made-byGoogle event – from the new Pixel phones to a new Google Home. Coincidentally last month also saw the release of Part 1 of this two Fastrack series on Google. In the first part we focussed more on the hardware side of things while this time around, we are going to focus on the lush ecosystem and software products that Google currently has on offer with a generous sprinkling of hardware to boot.

It is downright impossible that even a person with just rudimentary knowledge of technology has never heard of Google. In fact anyone who's ever come in contact with the internet has come in contact with at least one Google product – most likely their search engine or their browser. But how many of us truly realize the vast breadth of apps Google offers? It's easy to get hung up on Chrome and YouTube and what have you and overlook obscure gems such as Play Books. Google usually has an app (or truth be told, TWO apps) for pretty much most activities a smartphone user would seek, and while most of them are well and truly in the limelight, some tend to fall by the wayside. But, the average office worker or student can most definitely survive and even do very well with an all Google Ecosystem – this is where the concept and driving force behind Chromebooks comes in, and while it might not be as polished and seamless as say, Apple's, it's still pretty darn good.

Then of course, there are the obvious pitfalls of using a homogeneous ecosystem – Google gets ALL your data instead of just some. But in an increasingly digital life, this is a necessary evil that we unfortunately must bear. Understanding an ecosystem helps in both utilising it to the fullest and avoiding pitfalls. This is the fine line this FastTrack is trying straddle. Hopefully this issue can show you some of the more interesting parts of Google's ecosystem and by the end, leave you pretty knowledgeable of our lord and ~~tyrant~~ savior Google. 